There is no single data-centre career

Six pathways into Kenya's digital infrastructure. Each starts from a different base, and each ends up keeping facilities alive.



PART 2 · THE PATHWAYS 6 EXPLAINED

An engineer reviews racks on site. The route in can start from six different places.

PATHWAY 01 · POWER

Keep the electricity flowing

THE WORK	**UPS systems, generators, switchgear** and distribution - the chain from grid to rack
THE SKILLS	Electrical fundamentals, load management, safe isolation and switching
THE WAY IN	Electrical engineering degrees, electrician apprenticeships, technician diplomas

> **Power failures are the fastest way to lose a facility. Power people are hired first.**

PATHWAY 02 · COOLING

Manage the heat machines make

THE WORK	**Chillers, CRAC units, airflow and thermal management** across the hall
THE SKILLS	Mechanical and HVAC fundamentals, airflow diagnostics, preventive maintenance
THE WAY IN	Mechanical engineering, refrigeration and air-conditioning trade routes

> **Every watt a server draws becomes heat. Cooling is a full-time discipline.**

PATHWAY 03 · NETWORKS

Connect the facility to the world

THE WORK	**Patch panels, fibre splicing, meet-me rooms** and exchange connectivity
THE SKILLS	Fibre handling, structured cabling, network fundamentals, labelling discipline
THE WAY IN	Telecom courses, networking certifications, hands-on fibre practice

> **Kenya's subsea cables land here. Somebody splices every strand.**

PATHWAY 04 · CLOUD & COMPUTE

Run the servers themselves

THE WORK	**Server racks, GPU clusters, virtualization** and customer platforms
THE SKILLS	Operating systems, hardware diagnostics, scripting, cloud platforms
THE WAY IN	Computer science degrees, self-taught builders, certification routes

> **The room is physical. The product is digital. This pathway bridges both.**



PATHWAY 05 · SECURITY

Control who and what gets in

THE WORK	**Access control, CCTV, patrols** and coordinated incident response
THE SKILLS	Physical security operations, procedure discipline, calm under pressure
THE WAY IN	Security operations training, disciplined service backgrounds, site experience

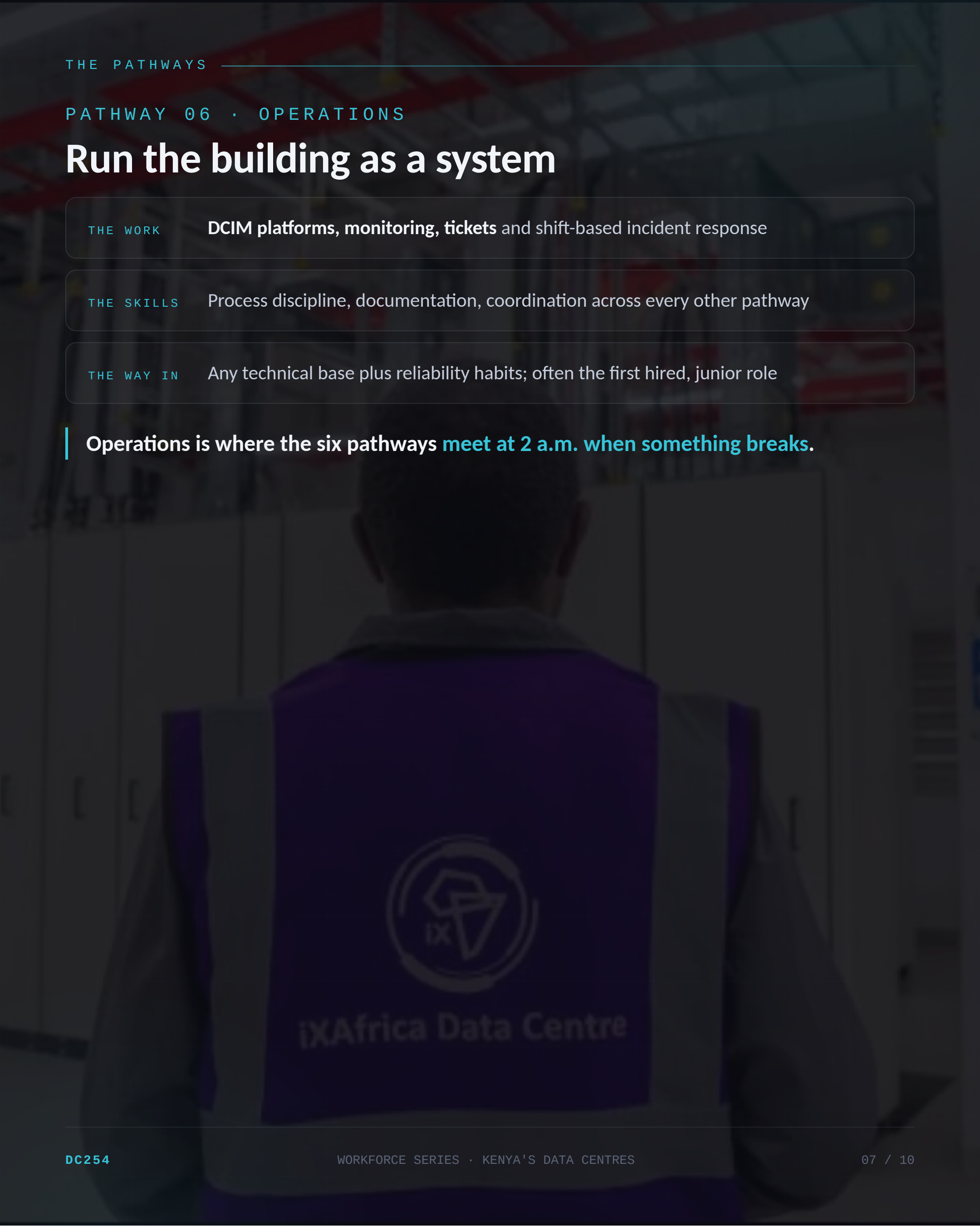
> **Every rack in the building is an asset someone will try to reach. Security decides whether they can.**

PATHWAY 06 · OPERATIONS

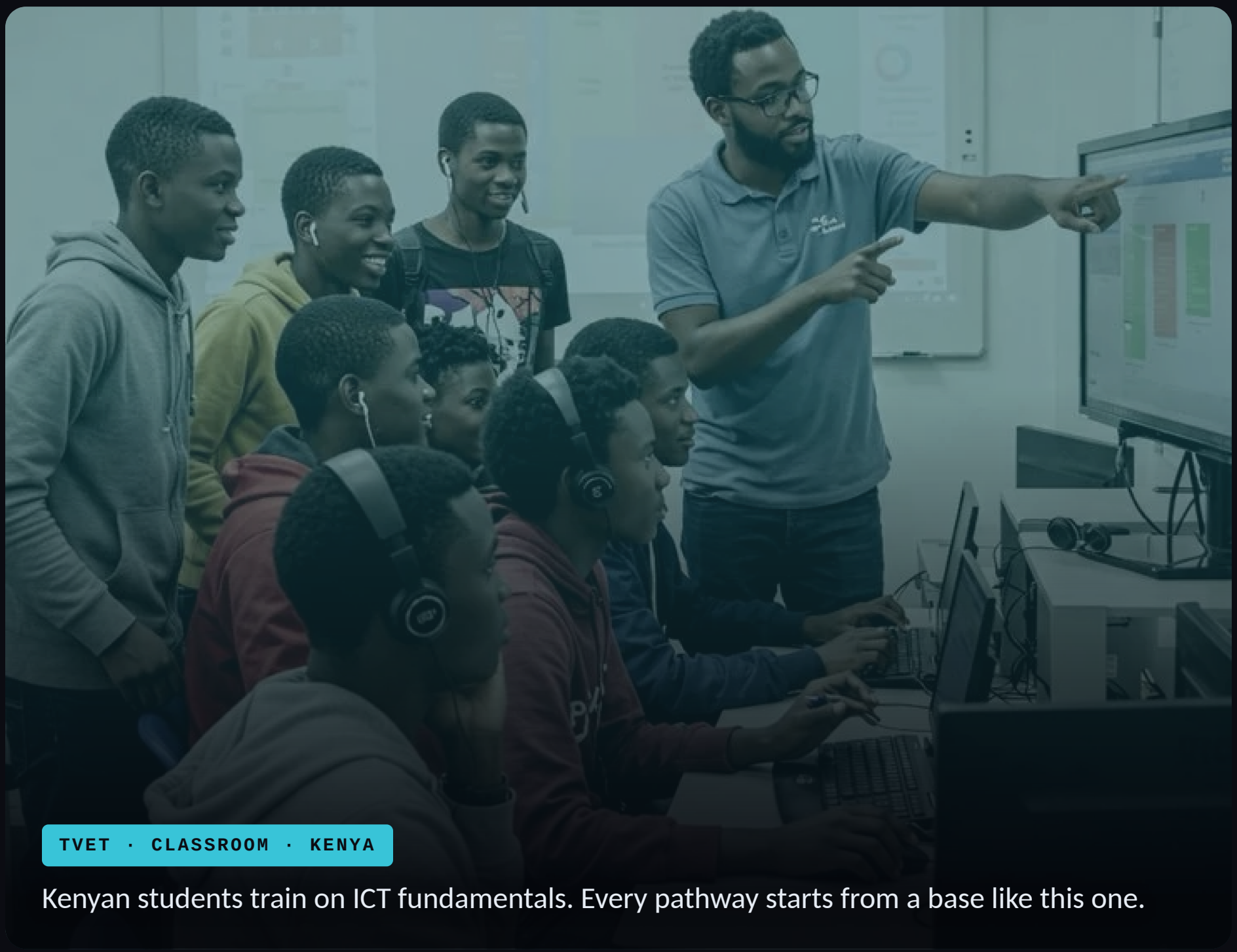
Run the building as a system

THE WORK	**DCIM platforms, monitoring, tickets** and shift-based incident response
THE SKILLS	Process discipline, documentation, coordination across every other pathway
THE WAY IN	Any technical base plus reliability habits; often the first hired, junior role

> **Operations is where the six pathways meet at 2 a.m. when something breaks.**



Four honest ways in



TVET · CLASSROOM · KENYA

Kenyan students train on ICT fundamentals. Every pathway starts from a base like this one.

TVET	Technical diplomas in electrical, mechanical and ICT fields
DEGREE	Engineering and computer science programmes
APPRENTICE	Junior technician and shift roles that teach on the job
CERTIFY	Industry certifications such as CDCP, layered on any of the above

WHAT EMPLOYERS VALUE

The habits the floor rewards

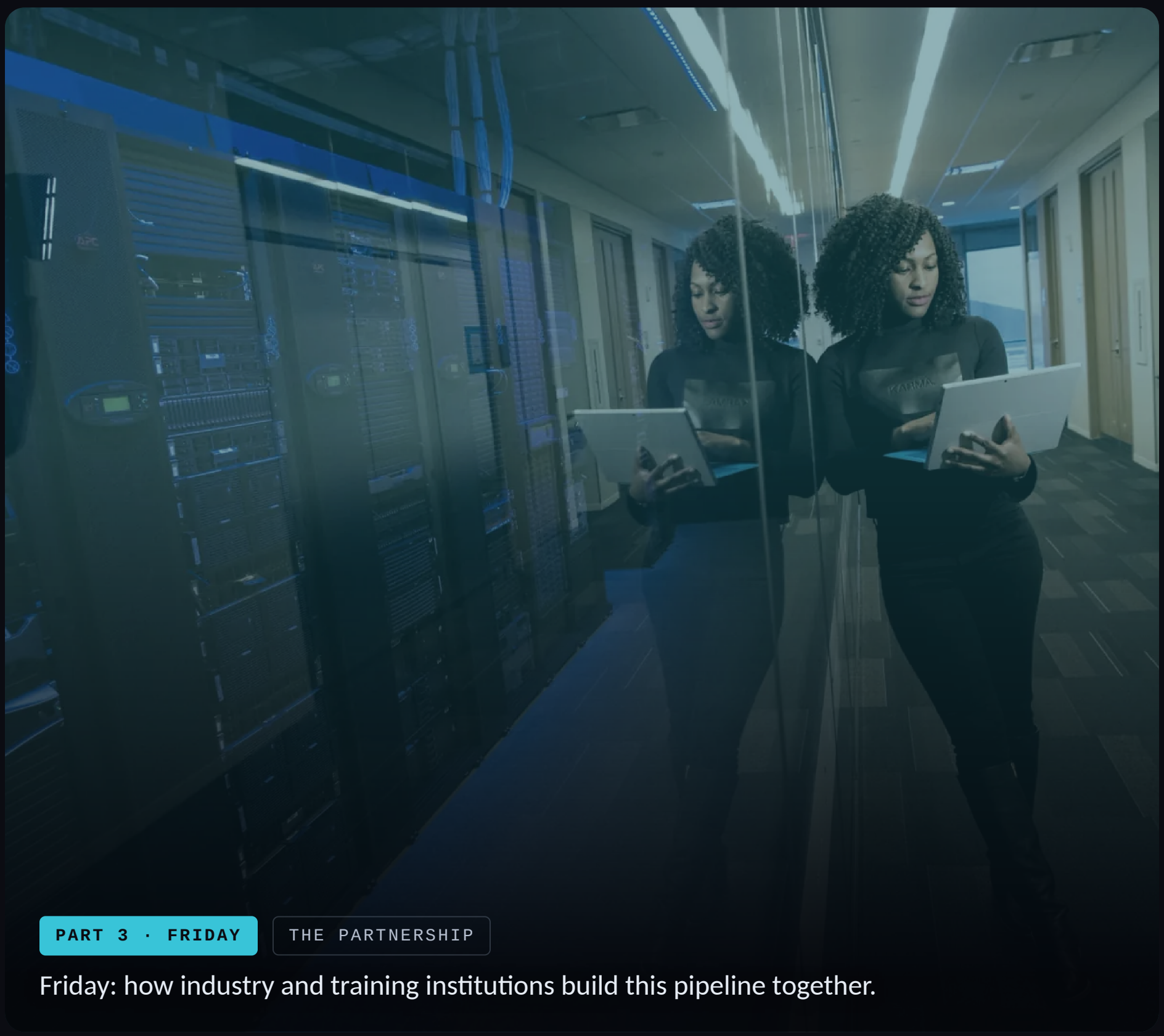
SAFETY	Treat electricity, heat and height with respect, every shift
RELIABILITY	Facilities run at 3 a.m. on weekends; shift work is the job
CURIOSITY	Troubleshooters who read manuals and ask questions move fastest
DOCUMENTATION	Write down what you did; the next shift depends on it

> **Diplomas open doors. Habits build careers.**

YOUR TURN

Which pathway should DC254 explain next?

We will build a full explainer for the pathway you ask for, with real entry routes and the skills each role uses daily.



PART 3 · FRIDAY

THE PARTNERSHIP

Friday: how industry and training institutions build this pipeline together.

CAREERS HUB

data-centers-254.vercel.app/careers